DEVELOPMENT TRENDS IN MODERN JOURNALISM PERCEPTION OF THE QUALITY OF NEWS CONTENT IN THE MASS MEDIA

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Abstract: This thesis examines the evaluation of news content quality and its perception by the audience in Uzbekistan. Based on a survey of 126 respondents, the following was revealed: the priority for news consumers is the reliability of facts, as well as conciseness—the inclusion of exclusively important details and the absence of non-essential information. Respondents noted the following shortcomings in the media: unreliable information and problems with content presentation (long, confusing, or boring texts, clickbait headlines). The results show that audience dissatisfaction is based on the non-compliance with fundamental journalistic standards, such as reliability and clarity, while technological aspects (publication speed, visualisation) are of secondary importance to the respondents.

Keywords: news content quality, information reliability, news presentation, society and mass media.

Annotatsiya: Ushbu tezisda O‘zbekistondagi yangiliklar kontenti sifatini baholash va uning auditoriya tomonidan qabul qilinishi o‘rganiladi. 126 nafar respondent bilan o‘tkazilgan so‘rov asosida quyidagilar aniqlandi: yangiliklar iste’molchilari uchun faktlarning ishonchliligi, shuningdek, lo‘ndalik: o‘ta muhim tafsilotlarni tasvirlash va ahamiyatsiz ma’lumotlarning yo‘qligi ustuvor ahamiyatga ega. Respondentlar OAVning quyidagi kamchiliklarini qayd etdilar: ma’lumotlarning ishonchsizligi va materialni taqdim etishdagi muammolar (uzun, chalkash yoki zerikarli matnlar, klikbeyt sarlavhalari). Natijalar shuni ko‘rsatadiki, auditoriyaning noroziliklari jurnalistikaning odatiy standartlariga rioya qilmaslikka asoslanadi, masalan: ishonchlilik va aniqlik, texnologik jihatlar (tezlik, vizualizatsiya) esa respondentlar uchun ikkinchi darajali ahamiyatga ega.

Kalit so‘zlar: yangiliklar mazmunining sifati, axborotning ishonchliligi, yangiliklar materialini taqdim etish, jamiyat va OAV.

Аннотация: В данном тезисе исследуется оценка качества новостного контента и восприятие его аудиторией в Узбекистане. На основе опроса 126 респондентов было выявлено следующее: приоритетом для потребителей новостей является достоверность фактов, а также лаконичность: описание исключительно важных деталей и отсутствие несущественной информации. Респонденты отметили следующие недостатки СМИ: недостоверность информации и проблемы с подачей материала (длинные, запутанные или скучные тексты, кликбейтные заголовки). Результаты показывают,

что недовольства аудитории основаны на несоблюдении привычных журналистских стандартов, такие как: достоверность и ясность, в то время как технологические аспекты (скорость, визуализация) имеют для опрашиваемых второстепенное значение.

Ключевые слова: качество новостного контента, достоверность информации, подача новостного материала, общество и СМИ.

The audience's evaluation of news content quality is primarily determined by the accuracy, reliability, and completeness of information, as well as readers' subjective views, including personal preferences for formats, presentation styles, and distribution channels [1]. The level of audience trust directly affects the effectiveness of mass media communication with information consumers. In the internet era, it also influences mass media resilience against competition from social media platforms [2]. Furthermore, the quality of journalistic text is analysed through a combination of content and structural characteristics, with the use of reliable sources and information relevance serving as key criteria for audience evaluation [3]. It is important to emphasise that audience perception shapes the value of a news message as much as generally accepted journalistic standards. Since any news publication primarily deals with readers, studying consumer evaluation of news quality remains highly relevant.

Results

The research results were based on an online survey conducted at the end of 2025, involving 126 respondents from Uzbekistan. The survey aimed to identify factors contributing to audience satisfaction and dissatisfaction with modern mass media, determine key criteria by which users judge the quality of news content, and reveal what readers wish to see in the work of contemporary news publications. The survey allowed participants to select multiple answers for a single question.

Analysis of responses to the question about reasons for dissatisfaction with mass media revealed that the most significant issues for the audience are the quality and form of information presentation. The largest proportion of respondents, 42.9% (54 people), cited excessively long, convoluted, or boring texts as a problem. An almost identical percentage, 41.3% (52 people), selected the option regarding unreliable or distorted information.

A significant portion of respondents – 31.7% (40 people) – expressed dissatisfaction with clickbait headlines that do not reflect the actual content of the articles. This technique is indeed effective in terms of capturing the audience's attention, which is a benefit for a news outlet. However, in the long run, such a practice ultimately only undermines trust in the news outlet itself, leading people to turn to it less and less as they

become aware of its reliance on clickbait. Moreover, this approach also alienates readers from other mass media sources; users increasingly stop believing the headlines they read, already anticipating yet another misinformation within. This creates a broader cycle of distrust, where scepticism towards one outlet gradually erodes confidence in the entire mass media.

In addition, 18.3% of respondents (23 individuals) indicated the neglect of important yet "inconvenient" topics, which can be interpreted as a manifestation of editorial selectivity and a constrained information agenda. Less prominent, yet still notable, issues included superficial coverage of topics at 14.3% (18 individuals) and poor handling of sources and references at 8.7% (11 individuals).

The analysis of questions concerning audience priorities when consuming news demonstrates that respondents are oriented toward information quality and reliability. The most important criterion was found to be the accuracy and verification of facts, which was selected by 57.1% of respondents (72 individuals). This indicator substantially exceeds all others and confirms the central role of trust in shaping the perceived value of news content.

At the same time, a considerable proportion of the audience directs its attention to text literacy (grammar and style) and the speed of news publication when selecting a news outlet. Specifically, text literacy was prioritised by 35.7% of respondents (45 individuals), while the speed of publication was valued by 30.2% (38 individuals). Thus, for the surveyed audience, it is important to see in the mass media a combination of demands for professional journalistic standards alongside operational efficiency. It should be noted that in the conditions of the digital mass media era, where news portals face fierce competition, it has become somewhat more challenging for mass media outlets to combine timeliness and quality. Visual accompaniment of materials (photographs, infographics, video) was important for 26.2% of respondents (33 individuals). The ability to discuss news in comments and communities was noted by 21.4% of surveyed participants (27 individuals).

Conclusion

The survey results demonstrate that users desire greater attention from journalists to the substance, presentation, and headlines of news content, along with more thorough fact-checking to prevent the distortion of information. Respondents also express a need for improved stylistic execution of news materials — specifically, fewer overloaded or unstructured texts and clickbait headlines. The latter, despite their short-term effectiveness in attracting attention, ultimately erode audience trust in the long run, not only toward the specific outlet but toward the broader news agenda as a whole.

The audience's dual prioritization of grammatical accuracy

and publication speed underscores a critical demand: the reconciliation of high journalistic standards with operational agility. This balance poses a central dilemma for mass media in the digital age. Empirical data from this research corroborates that the sustainable development of modern news outlets is impossible without a focus on the consumers of the news themselves.

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